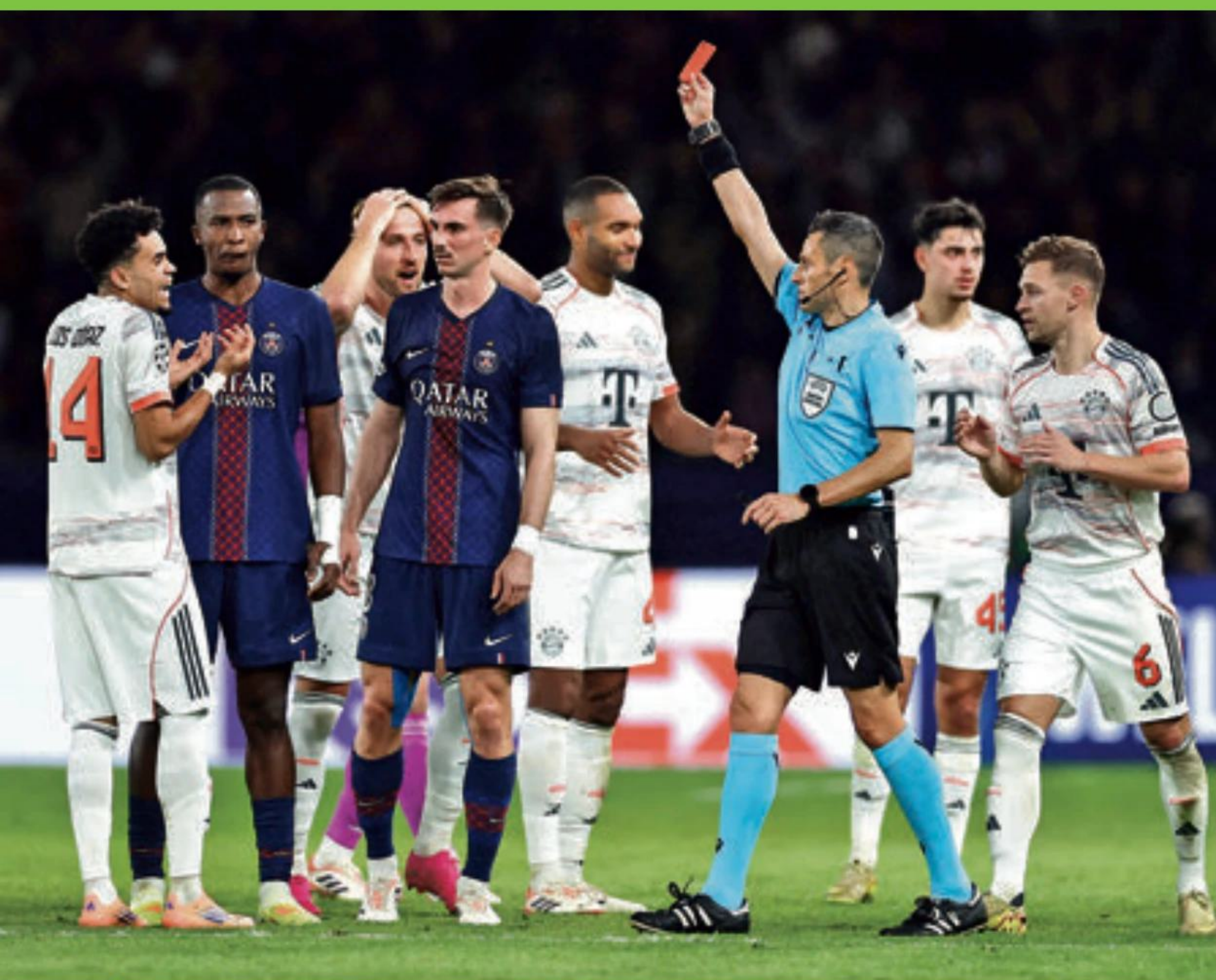




Mixed fortunes: Bayern Munich's Luis Diaz (extreme left) scored twice before being sent off for a bad challenge. REUTERS

and fourth, while Leverkusen (20) is fifth.

Serie A

The biggest news from matchday 11 of Italy's top flight was defending champion Napoli's 0-2 loss against Bologna, meaning Napoli dropped points for the second consecutive league game after drawing its previous one against Como.

Roma notched a 2-0 win against Udinese, while Inter beat Lazio by the same margin.

AC Milan and Juventus ended up dropping points after draws against Parma and Torino, respectively.

According to the latest standings, Inter (24) leads the Scudetto race, with Roma (24) second only by goal difference. Milan and Napoli — both on 22 — are third and fourth, while Juventus (19) is sixth.

Ligue 1

PSG and Lyon played out the game of the week in French top-flight football, with Luis Enrique's men winning 3-2

courtesy of a 90+5-minute winner by Joao Neves. Marseille had an easy day at the office, beating Brest 3-0.

Strasbourg and Lens won their respective matches against LOSC Lille and Monaco. At the end of matchday 12, PSG (27) leads the table, with Marseille (25), Lens (25) and Strasbourg (22) in second, third and fourth.

UEFA Champions League

English teams mostly dominated proceedings as the league phase of the UEFA Champions League reached its midway point. Arsenal, which is yet to concede in the competition, strengthened its position at the top of the table with a comfortable win against Slavia Praha, thanks to a penalty from Bukayo Saka and a double from Mikel Merino. The game also saw Max Dowman become the youngest player to feature in a Champions League game (15 years and 308 days), breaking Youssoufa Moukoko's 2020 record (16 years and 18 days) set while playing for Borussia Dortmund.

Manchester City also kept its unbeaten start intact with a dominant 4-1 win against German giant Borussia Dortmund. Erling Haaland scored against his former club, while

Phil Foden netted two identical goals from outside the box to propel City to fourth in the standings.

Liverpool faced the toughest task among English teams this week as it hosted record champion Real Madrid. However, even with a recent dip in form, the Reds turned up on the night and repeatedly tested Thibaut Courtois, who made eight saves. In the end, Alexis Mac Allister's header from a Dominik Szoboszlai free kick proved decisive as Liverpool claimed all three points. Newcastle United and Tottenham Hotspur had easy outings against Copenhagen and Athletic Club, respectively, while Chelsea was the only English club to drop points — drawing 2-2 with Qarabag FK.

The marquee clash of the gameweek took place at Parc des Princes in Paris, where defending champion PSG hosted Bayern Munich. Bayern's Luis Diaz had a very eventful first half, scoring twice before being sent off for a bad challenge on Achraf Hakimi. Joao Neves halved the deficit for the Parisians, but could not find an equaliser as the home side fell to its first defeat in the competition since last season's quarterfinal second leg against Aston Villa.

Elsewhere, Barcelona dropped points after a 3-3 draw with Club Brugge. The Catalan side had to level the score three times, with Ferran Torres and Lamine Yamal netting one each before Christos Tzolis scored an own goal to help Barca escape with a point. Meanwhile, Inter Milan maintained its perfect start with a hard-fought 2-1 win against Kairat Almaty, thanks to goals from Lautaro Martinez and Carlos Augusto.

With four matchweeks left, only Bayern, Arsenal and Inter have perfect records with 12 points, while Man City sits fourth with 10. At the other end, Benfica and Ajax remain without a point after four matches.

World Cup qualifiers

"I swear that I'm going to try to be a good boy," said Cristiano Ronaldo (**facing page**) at the pre-match press conference for Portugal's FIFA World Cup 2026 qualifier against Ireland.

However, on the night, the 'good